[1] *Madras Police Abstracts of Intelligence* (MPAI), 1906, para 231. This CID report refers to the date 20 April; I have relied on VOC's letter of 12 April 1906 which notes the date 10 April while mentioning that the second steamer was due on 20 April. From this we may surmise that the first chartered Swadeshi steamer, the *Shah Amere* arrived on 10 April and the second, the *Shah Allum*, arrived ten days later.

[2] The Shah Line Company apparently led 'an Ishmaelitish kind of existence for some time', and did not make much money and became the Shah Steam Navigation Company in mid-1906. The company was soon involved in a ruthless rate war with the British India Steam Navigation Company and was finally sold to the latter. Coates, *The Old 'Country Trade' of the East Indies*, pp. 100, 202.

[3] In British India, the executive also wielded judicial powers, and therefore the head of the district was designated collector (executive/revenue powers) and magistrate (judicial powers). As we shall see, this had grave implications for SSNCo. It was a longstanding demand of the Congress that the powers be separated.

[4] MPAI, 1906, para 231. While the police report was filed on 21 April, the district collector's remark is dated 30 April. See note 1 above: the CID had missed the arrival of the first steamer.

[5] *Ceylon Observer* (weekly edition), 6-4-1906; 12-4-1906.

[6] *Times of Ceylon*'s report reprinted in *Times of India*, 13-4-1906.

[7] *Swadesamitran*, 11-4-1906, editorial.

[8] *Swadesamitran*, 20-4-1906. For another epistle from the same correspondent, on the devotion of Muslims to the Swadeshi creed, see *Swadesamitran*, 14-6-1906.

[9] Unfortunately, not a single issue of *Swadesamitran* from 1907 has survived. The loss of Bharati's weekly *India* for the period between July 1907 and August 1908, save a handful of issues, is another major handicap in reconstructing the history of SSNCo.

[10] *Swadesamitran*, 26-4-1906.

[11] Pate, *Madras District Gazetteers: Tinnevelly*, p. 329.

[12] IOL: L/P&J/6/857.

[13] VOC, *Suyasarithai*, pp. 39–43.